



SAFETY LEADERSHIP KEYNOTE

Zero Incidents Is a Culture

ZERO IS NOT A NUMBER YOU HIT - IT IS A CULTURE YOU BUILD.

THE TALK

Every jobsite has a banner promising zero. Most of them are a wish. Brad draws the hard line between a safety program that looks good on paper and a culture that actually keeps people alive, and explains why chasing zero as a target can quietly make a site more dangerous, not less.

From a championship emergency-response team to running power at forty below in the oil sands, he shows what real safety culture feels like from the inside: honesty made easy, stop-work that is genuinely respected, and crews that watch out for each other when no one is checking. It is four decades of field experience turned into something a room can act on the next morning.

WHAT THE ROOM WALKS AWAY WITH

- Why "zero" as a target backfires, and what to measure instead.
- Compliance is the floor, not the house. The difference between paperwork and protection.
- The drift: how good crews slide into danger one small shortcut at a time.
- Make honesty the easy path, so near-misses surface before they become incidents.
- Stop-work only counts when the youngest person on site feels safe to use it.

THE MOMENT A CULTURE IS MADE

A worker once told Brad, in front of the whole crew, about a near-miss nobody would ever have known about. What Brad did in the next thirty seconds decided whether that crew would ever tell him the truth again.

THE CORE SHIFT

BUILD THE IDENTITY

Safe becomes who the crew is, not a rule they comply with.

MAKE HONESTY CHEAP

Reward the report. Never punish the person who tells the truth.

MEASURE BEHAVIOR

Track near-misses and stop-works, not just the injury count.

IDEAL FOR

Construction and industrial employers · Safety days and summits · Trade associations and unions · Site leadership and supervisors · Any high-hazard workforce

FORMATS

Signature keynote	45-60 min
Safety-day slot	25-30 min
Keynote + facilitated session	60-90 min

Brad Gard - Master Electrician & Training Director, IBEW Local 120. NCSO, CSA Z462, four decades in the field including temporary power in the oil sands. Recent keynote: NETCO, Charlevoix.

BOOK THIS KEYNOTE

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